

Lana Karazoun

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Financial analyst with 4 years at Citibank serving as a trusted financial partner to business leaders, using data-driven insights to support strategic decision-making and operational success. Experienced independently managing financial reporting, analysis, and accounting processes across complex portfolios; performing budget forecasting and variance analysis; preparing and validating financial and regulatory reports; and acting as the primary financial liaison for assigned business functions. Strong analytical, problem-solving, and communication skills with a track record of delivering accurate, compliance-ready financial outputs; pursuing an MBA in Data Analytics.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Citibank Finance Regulatory & Data Analyst

Tampa, FL | Aug 2022 - May 2026

Financial Reporting, Analysis & Accounting

- Developed, improved, and maintained financial reporting, analysis, and accounting processes across Finance and Risk, independently managing recurring and ad hoc reporting cycles for senior business and operational leaders.
- Researched and analyzed moderately complex financial, accounting, and operational issues, providing data-driven insights and actionable recommendations to support strategic decision-making across multiple business lines.
- Prepared and validated financial and regulatory reports to ensure accuracy and compliance with GAAP standards and applicable federal regulations, maintaining audit-ready documentation throughout all reporting cycles.

Budget Development, Forecasting & Variance Analysis

- Supported operating budget development and annual budget preparation by gathering financial data, identifying spending trends, and developing financial projections and forecasts at monthly, quarterly, and yearly intervals.
- Performed budget-to-actuals variance analysis across multiple accounts, advising leadership on areas of over and under allocation and recommending budget transfers and reallocations as needed.
- Completed in-year forecasting and historical trend analysis reports, building automated reporting models that improved visibility into spending trends and reduced manual reporting time by ~40%.

Financial Liaison & Stakeholder Partnership

- Acted as the primary financial liaison for assigned business functions, collaborating with Directors, Senior Managers, and cross-functional partners to resolve complex financial issues and provide accurate, timely information for budget and reporting inquiries.
- Delivered exceptional service to internal stakeholders while managing multiple priorities, maintaining consistent accuracy and compliance across all financial outputs and reporting deliverables.
- Participated in and led finance projects of increasing complexity, building leadership capabilities and contributing to process improvement initiatives that enhanced reporting efficiency and data quality.

Data, Compliance & Process Improvement

- Leveraged enterprise reporting tools including Power BI, Tableau, and SQL to deliver data-driven financial insights, developing dashboards and self-service reporting solutions aligned to business priorities.
- Reconciled accounts monthly, identifying discrepancies and ensuring alignment with financial control standards; reviewed and adjusted initial reconciliations completed by junior team members.
- Built 10+ automation workflows using KNIME and SQL, reducing manual workload by ~40% and improving reporting accuracy by ~80% through optimized data pipelines and validated outputs.

LOFT Customer Operations Associate

Tampa, FL | Aug 2018 - Jul 2020

- Exceeded sales targets by 20-30% through strong communication, customer engagement, and operational accuracy, developing foundational skills in client service and cross-team coordination.

TECHNICAL & ANALYTICAL SKILLS

Financial & Administrative: Budget-to-Actuals Analysis, Forecasting, Variance Analysis, Financial Reporting, Account Reconciliation, Regulatory Compliance, Internal Controls, Audit Readiness, Accounts Payable/Receivable, Payroll Monitoring

Technical: SQL, Excel (Advanced), Tableau, Power BI, MS Copilot, KNIME Automation, Enterprise Data Warehouse (EDW) reporting

Analytics: Trend Analysis, Financial Projections, KPI Development, Root Cause Analysis, Data Quality Management, Process Improvement, Self-Service Reporting

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

University of South Florida - MBA, Data Analytics Concentration (In Progress), Tampa, FL, Expected 2027

Relevant: Financial Analysis, Statistical Modeling, Data-Driven Decision Making, Database Design, Systems Analysis

University of South Florida - BS, Business Analytics & Information Systems, Tampa, FL

Certifications: CBAP (In Progress), Data Science - Tableau, Microsoft Office Specialist, Business Analysis Grad Cert, USF (In Progress)